

Dr. Ramesh Kancharla
Chairman and Managing Director
Rainbow Children's Hospital

extends beyond clinical considerations to creating a child-friendly environment that fosters acceptance and comfort.

Rainbow works on institutional setup with collaborative approach to ensure excellent patient care, outcomes, training and research. This is perhaps the result of low attrition of doctors. "Despite the challenging times of COVID, our doctors produced about 100 research papers through publications. This is testimony of their commitment.", appreciates Dr Ramesh. "Rainbow invested significantly on IT infrastructure and it is building a robust digital ecosystem to provide greater interaction with the patients and deliver care to extended geographies including international patients.", he mentions.

Rainbow super specialty services have built very large departments delivering highest level of care for neurological problems, liver and gastrointestinal problems, childhood cancers, renal problems and advanced laparoscopic surgery services for children. Rainbow embarked its journey to offer pediatric quaternary care services like complex cardiac surgeries, neuro surgeries and organ transplantation for liver, kidney and bone marrow transplantation. Today, they deliver results on par with international standards. As a result of regular brainstorming and teamwork that they could work on these core areas and also devise an integrated one, understanding the need for the amalgamation of perinatal services within the children's hospital to attend to neonatal medical and surgical problems efficiently and immediately.

"We follow a hub-and-spoke model, while the hub hospital provides multi-specialty pediatric services with advanced tertiary and quaternary care services, the spokes offer comprehensive outpatient and inpatient services, besides 24-hour emergency care, for an excellent coverage across cities. The model provides considerable synergies and ensures better care and accessibility of advanced healthcare for a larger patient pool.", he explains.

A range of health problems that arise during infancy carry forward into adult life if medical intervention is inaccessible at the appropriate time. These include congenital heart diseases that affect approximately one-fifth of the infants. With the intent to address these issues, Rainbow Group also runs an exclusive 110-bed Children's Cardiac Center called Rainbow Children's Heart Institute, performs 60 surgeries on an average, monthly and 700 surgeries and over 750 cardiac catherization procedures including device closure of congenital heart defects, annually.

The success and expertise of the group can be fathomed considering that Rainbow is successfully treating over a 1.2 million outpatients, discharging close to a million patients per annum of which over 12,000 very sick patients from the NICU and PICU and are doing over 15,000 low risk and high-risk deliveries together, annually. Commendably, 75% of the surgeries they perform are laparoscopic.

Rainbow Children's Hospital runs on organic model and has digitally native patients. It, with due diligence has succeeded in delivering excellent care to the tiniest of babies and saving the sickest of them. They have earned many national and international accolades. They earned a place in the Limca Book of Records for saving a baby born with 375gms of birth weight and a place in the Guinness Book of World Records for 'the largest gathering of people born prematurely'.

A healthy nation is defined by healthy healthcare indices like neonatal, infant and maternal mortality rate. To achieve that, Dr Ramesh says, "The healthcare delivery system needs a revamp ensuring well-trained and skilled manpower such as paramedics, nurses, and doctors. The task is to maintain both quality and quantity." Over the two decades, Rainbow has built robust children's healthcare model with 24/7 emergency care, transport services which includes transporting critically sick babies and children from districts as far as 250 kms from the hub hospitals. Notably, almost 1/3rd of beds at Rainbow are alloted to newborn and pediatric intensive care services.

Rainbow believes in training and academics. It runs the country's largest academic program in the private sector, offering PG DNB program and fellowship in intensive care and various super specialties along with the opportunities for the trainees to pursue their career to become consultants.

Dr. Ramesh has proven himself an exceptional achiever and has been bestowed with prestigious awards and accolades like the "Lifetime Achiever of the Year in Pediatric Gastroenterology & Hepatology by the Times of India" in the year 2017, "Telangana's Best Healthcare Professional Award 2017", and the "Entrepreneur of the Year" award by the Sakshi Media Group in 2018.

While the achievement of getting listed on exchanges was commendable, it was undeniably a challenging feat amidst the prevailing uncertainty in capital markets and the limited availability of information regarding pediatric hospitals. As a result, analysts and investors lacked peer comparisons within the listed universe.

Dr. Ramesh perceives this as a distinctive opportunity to champion specialized healthcare tailored to meet the unique needs of children, particularly within the investor community. He is filled with a profound sense of enthusiasm as he evangelizes the indispensable necessity for children's hospitals in India. Rainbow believes that opportunities of children healthcare is huge. It is because of nuclearization of Indian families, significant increase of nuclear families, insurance penetration, healthcare awareness and overall growth of country. These are compelling factors to build child healthcare to provide better healthcare to children.

Rainbow continues to believe in disciplined expansions with a modern infrastructure, child centric environment, unique doctor engagement model to deliver multi-disciplinary care and aims to strengthen their presence in existing cities and new locations including Delhi NCR.